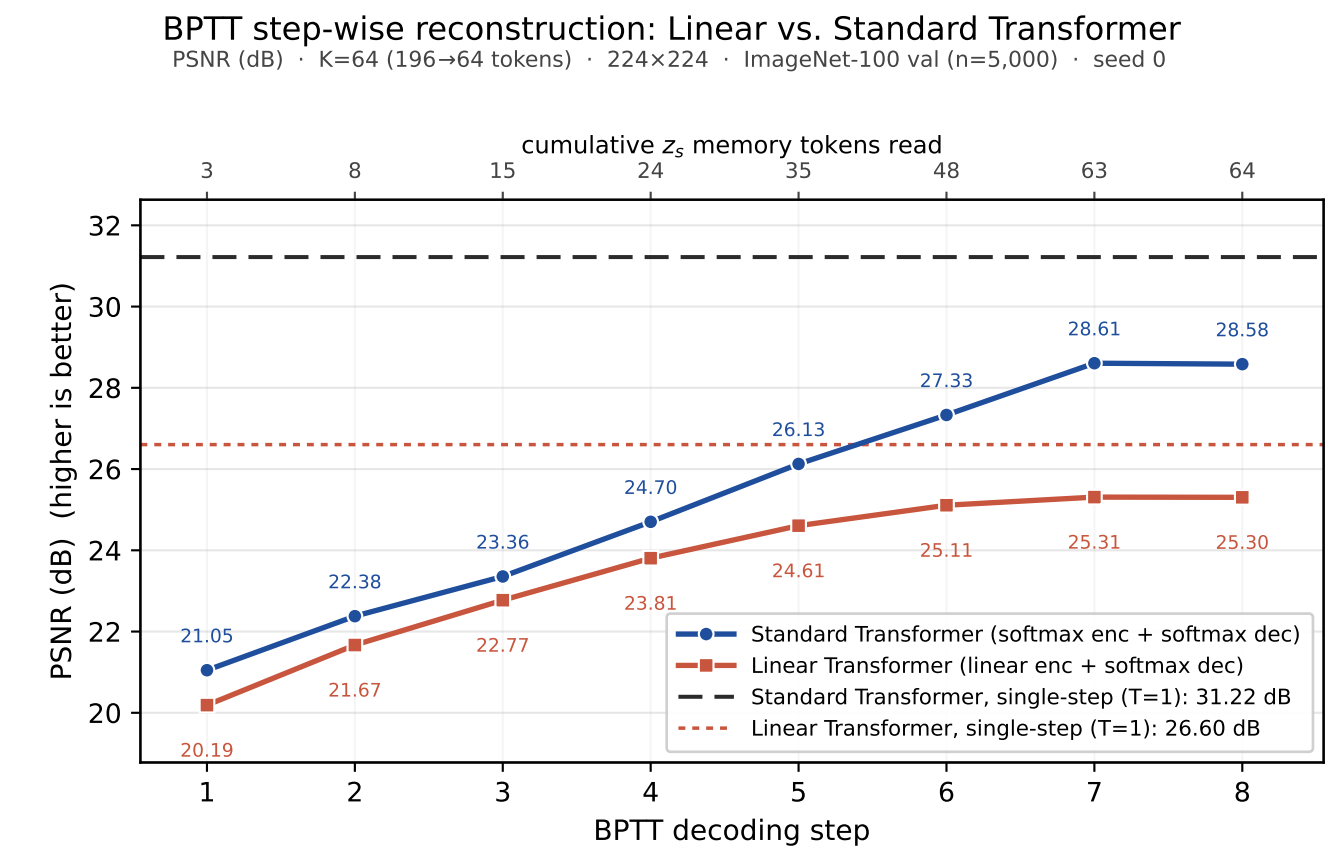

Caveat — training budgets differ: BPTT arms are 6-epoch warm starts (11,406 steps) from their T=1 checkpoints; the T=1 baselines are 45-epoch runs from scratch (42,750 steps). The dashed line is a reference point, NOT a paired ablation. Single seed.